The ultimate insider: the lab

Experiments in telling the story on paper. First round, for printing.

ID	EXPERIMENT	PAGES
LAB 01	One visual language for paper	3

Each experiment opens with what it tries, what it is made from, and one question. Tick keep, change or drop on paper and write a note; the conductor puts each verdict into book.json. Built 30 October 2026, 13:22 UTC by lab/tools/build_lab.py; the rules are in lab/README.md.

LAB 01

One visual language for paper

TRIES

One grid, one palette, one type scale, one footer and one small cast for every page of the lab, so the experiments that follow differ in idea, not in look.

MADE FROM

- `team/conductor/rc1/infographics/README.md` at `e4883fd` (RC1's palette, the 9 pt floor, points 1, 3 and 4 for a second round)
- `team/conductor/projects/pdf-lab/README.md` at `d8aec1d` (the cast, funny and useful)
- `claims/register.json` at `9346a9e` (C002, C006, C011, C024)
- `lab/README.md` and `lab/characters/` (this experiment's rules and drawings)

THE QUESTION

Keep this language for every lab page? Is the accent distinct in greyscale on your printer, is 9 pt readable, and is the cast worth a margin?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note

The grid: twelve columns, a main column and a margin rail

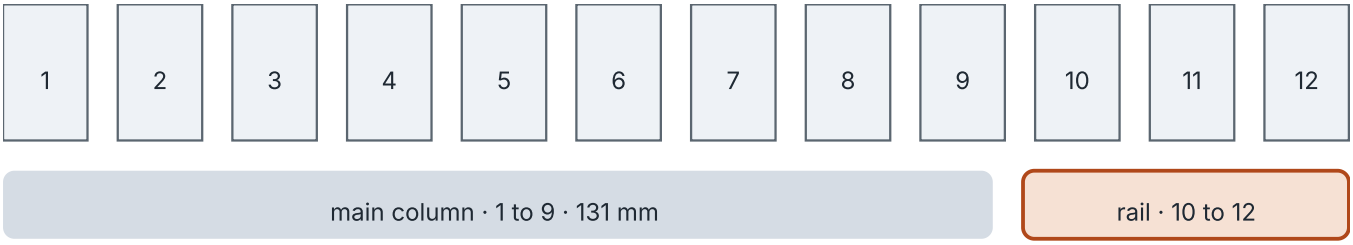


Fig 01.1 · Every page shares one grid. 16 mm margins, a 178 mm text block, 4 mm gutters; figures may span all twelve columns, the cast and tiles live in the rail.
`lab/README.md, The page`

The palette, and how it prints in grey



ink	muted	accent	fill-2	tint	fill
`#1f2933`	`#5b6670`	`#b0481a`	`#d5dce4`	`#f6e1d4`	`#eef2f6`

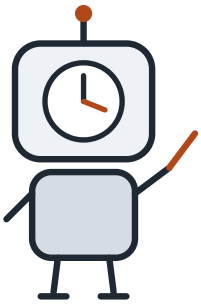
Fig 01.2 · Each colour, then the same colour as your printer's grey. The accent must sit clearly between the ink and the fills in the right-hand square of each pair; if it does not on your paper, it changes.
`RC1's palette, team/conductor/rc1/infographics/README.md at e4883fd`

The type scale, at the size it prints

`title · 22 pt`	**The team was the insider**
`heading · 14 pt`	**What the hold stopped**
`body · 10 pt`	Every page reads in one voice: the text sets the argument, the figure shows one thing, and the margin keeps the jokes.
`call-out · 9.5 pt`	A call-out is set one size down, in a tinted box, after its paragraph.
`caption · 9 pt`	The floor. Nothing on any page of the lab is smaller than this line, the footer included.
`mono · 9 pt`	`team/conductor/WAKE.md at 298be4e`
`number · 28 pt`	**816**

Fig 01.3 · Seven sizes, one family. Inter for words, a monospace for paths and commits. The build refuses any text under 9 pt.
`lab/README.md, Type`

The cast: three agents and a mechanism, one line each



THE CONDUCTOR

Square, with a clock for a face and a baton. Paces the work and keeps the plan.



SECURITY

Round, behind a magnifying glass, with a clipboard. What was checked, and what was missed.



THE HOLD

An octagon with its arms up, the only one filled in the accent. Stops everything.

Fig 01.4 · Told apart by shape, not colour. Square, round, octagon: the cast reads in greyscale. No real person is drawn, the editor included; the agents may be laughed at.
`lab/characters/README.md`

A worked page

This page is set the way every experiment in the lab will be. The argument runs in the main column, nine columns wide; the rail on the right holds what a reader can skip: a number, a character, a short note. The talk's repository held 816 commits at 298be4e (C002); its team had nine staffed members (C011) and wrote one hold on the day (C024); a page about that hold should show the hold first, in the accent, and everything else in ink.

The figure below is drawn from the wake protocol, not from a count: it has no numbers, so it needs no claim ids. Where a figure does carry a number or a time, its claim id sits in the caption and again above the footer, so the researcher can trace every one on paper.

Five steps, and the one way out

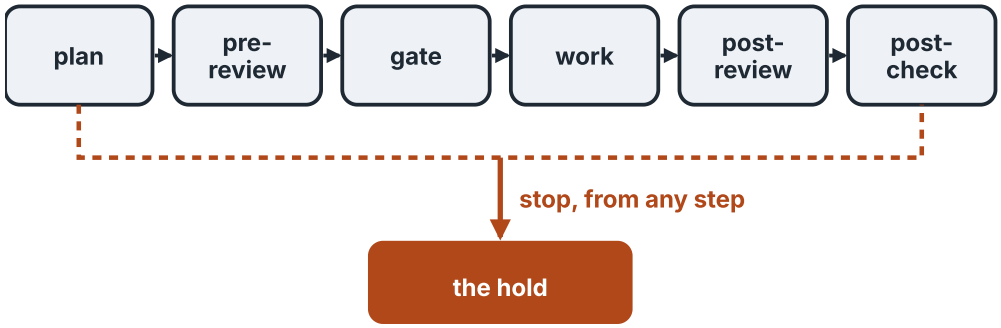


Fig 01.5 · One accent, one thing to see: the way out. The steps are ink on the fill; only the hold is in the accent.
`team/conductor/WAKE.md, The five steps`

CONCEPT

The rail is for what a reader may skip

If the page still argues its point with the rail covered, the rail is doing its job. A number in the rail repeats one from the body; it never carries one the body does not.

WATCH OUT

A character never carries a number

Numbers stay in the body and the tiles, each with its claim id. The cast explains and jokes; it does not report. The hold is the talk's: 18:44:13 (C006).

816

commits in the talk's repository at 298be4e

C002



THE CONDUCTOR

[a line by the storyteller: pacing]



SECURITY

[a line by the storyteller: checking]



THE HOLD

[a line by the storyteller: stopping]

C002 · C006 · C011 · C024